

PROBLEM STATEMENT 07

Attendance, Mess, Hostel, Repeat: Campus Life, Debugged

Organisation: Fretbox

Four apps, six notice boards, two WhatsApp groups and one register. Replace all of it.

SUMMARY

Design a technology solution that removes the daily friction of campus life — for the student trying to get something done, and for the administrator trying to keep track of two thousand of them. Not a new app for one problem. A working answer to the everyday operational mess that everyone has quietly accepted as normal.

OUTCOMES

- Routine campus tasks completed in one place instead of five queues and a phone call
- Administrators with real visibility into what is pending, where, and for whom
- Faster resolution of complaints, requests and approvals, with an audit trail
- Fewer notices lost to a WhatsApp group at 2 AM
- A solution that works for a student on a low-end phone and a patchy hostel network

OVERVIEW

Campus life runs on a strange mixture of registers, notice boards, WhatsApp forwards, printed forms and one person who knows how everything actually works. Attendance is tracked in one system, hostel complaints in a diary, mess feedback nowhere, gate passes on paper, fee queries in a queue outside an office that opens at 11. Students lose hours to it. Administrators lose visibility to it. Both sides assume this is simply how college works.

THE STORY

It is Tuesday. A student needs a bonafide certificate, wants to report that the hostel tap has been leaking for nine days, would like to know whether tomorrow's class is cancelled, and has been told the mess menu changed. This requires: one office, one warden, one notice board, and one senior who "usually knows." Total time: most of the afternoon. Total number of these tasks that genuinely needed a human being: roughly zero.

DETAILED BRIEF

Build a prototype that simplifies everyday campus life across both sides of the counter. Teams may address a combination of:

- Student-side daily operations — attendance visibility, timetable and class updates, leave and gate-pass requests, document and certificate requests, fee and dues status, notices and announcements

- Hostel and facility operations — complaint and maintenance ticketing with status tracking, room and asset records, mess menu and feedback, visitor and gate logs
- Communication — targeted notifications by batch, branch, hostel or year, replacing broadcast WhatsApp chaos, with read and action tracking
- Administrator side — a single view of pending requests, complaint ageing, repeat issues, resolution times and workload distribution across staff
- Accessibility and reality checks — low-bandwidth operation, low-end device support, regional language support, and a path for students who genuinely have no smartphone
- Optional intelligence — routing complaints to the right department automatically, detecting recurring issues, predicting demand on facilities, or a chatbot that answers the twenty questions the office is asked every single day

DELIVERABLES

- A working prototype covering at least three distinct everyday campus workflows, end to end, from student request to administrator resolution
- An administrator dashboard showing pending items, ageing, resolution time and recurring issue patterns
- A notification and communication layer with targeting and delivery/action tracking
- An accessibility demonstration — the flow working on a low-end device or a poor connection, plus the fallback for students without smartphones
- An adoption note: how a college with existing systems and existing habits would actually roll this out, and what data it would need to migrate

EVALUATION CRITERIA

CRITERION	WEIGHTAGE
Real reduction in everyday friction for students and administrators	30%
Breadth and completeness of the workflows implemented	20%
Administrator visibility, tracking and actionable insight	20%
Accessibility, low-bandwidth and low-end device readiness	15%
Usability, adoption realism and demo quality	15%